



your brain



Claude

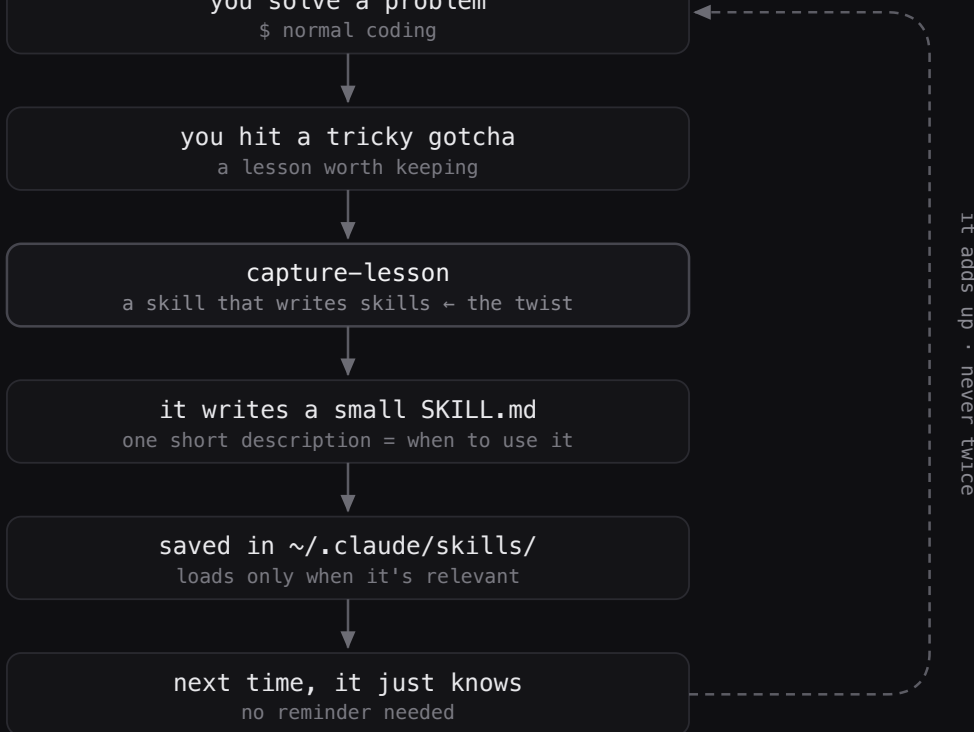
your agent already has the genius. this just gives it the hippocampus.

// your agent is brilliant – and forgets it all by morning

\$ let Claude Code learn as it goes

You explain a fix, it works – and by next session the agent has forgotten it ever happened. Brilliant, and amnesiac. This saves each hard-won lesson as a small **Skill** it reaches for on its own, so it stops re-making the same mistake. Built on what Claude already has (**memory + Skills**); the one new trick is a Skill whose only job is to **write other Skills**. The sort of thing that looks obvious about thirty seconds after you see it.

00 · THE LOOP



01 · THE IDEA

a lesson told to a chat dies with the chat.
a lesson saved as a **Skill** comes back on its own – only when it's needed,
and free until then.
(cells that fire together wire together; chats that end together forget together.)

02 · WHERE SKILLS LIVE

```
~/.claude/skills/           # yours, in every project
├─ capture-lesson/SKILL.md  # the skill that writes skills
├─ macos-long-render/SKILL.md # example 1
├─ citations/               # example 2
│   └─ SKILL.md
└─ scripts/check-citations.py
```

<project>/~/.claude/skills/ # or just for one repo

03 · A SKILL IS JUST A FOLDER + A SKILL.MD · EXAMPLE 1

```
---
name: macos-long-render
description: Wrap long Mac renders / video encodes / training in
  caffeinate so the Mac can't fall asleep and stall them. <- when to use it
  # write this like the moment you'd reach for it. too vague = never used.
---
## the fix
caffeinate -dimsu python3 long_job.py
## how to spot it
# steady, then a sudden cliff overnight = it slept. (not heat.)
```

where it came from: "17s/frame seems like a lot" – a real moment, mid-render.

04 · EXAMPLE 2 · A SKILL CAN CARRY ITS OWN HELPER

```
---
name: citations
description: Add or check numbered citations in a doc (esp. HTML).
  Check each source is real; keep the numbers lined up with the list.
---
## the trap
# a 2nd numbered list in HTML restarts at 1 → footnote [33] points wrong.
## the fix
one list, or set start= on the next one. then run the checker:
python3 ${CLAUDE_SKILL_DIR}/scripts/check-citations.py file.html
```

where it came from: "there was a citation problem." Its checker later confirmed an older project was actually fine – in one command.

05 · THE TWIST – A SKILL THAT WRITES SKILLS

capture-lesson is itself a skill. say "remember this" – or just
solve something gnarly – and it writes the lesson down as a new skill
(or tweaks one you already have). the agent grows its own toolbox.
(yes, a skill that writes skills. the recursion bottoms out – we checked.)

06 · THIS WAY VS. THE USUAL WAY

	the usual way – one notes file per skill	this way – a small skill per lesson
where it's kept	a growing log inside the skill	its own little skill
when it loads	every run, needed or not	only when it's relevant
a lesson that helps everywhere	stuck inside one skill	becomes its own – helps everywhere
as it piles up	gets long and noisy	stays tidy; drop what you don't use
what you keep	everything, by hand	just what keeps coming up

07 · WHERE SHOULD A THING GO?

a how-to / a gotcha + its fix → a Skill (comes back on its own)
a fact that's always true → CLAUDE.md
something about you or the project → memory
then leave one memory note: "save lessons as skills" –
so the **habit** itself sticks across sessions.

08 · WHY IT WORKS – HOW MEMORY ACTUALLY DOES IT

Your brain doesn't record everything. It works in two passes. A fast part (the hippocampus) grabs what just happened. A slower part (the cortex) takes the bits that matter and rewrites them into steady, reusable knowledge – without scribbling over what's already there.¹ AI agents are now built the same way.² The match is simple: jotting a lesson down is the fast grab; turning it into a Skill is the slow, lasting copy. And the wiring is real – cells that fire together strengthen their link (Hebb's rule³, later measured directly⁴). A bug you keep hitting is that kind of repeated pattern; the Skill locks it in.

The trick is not saving everything. If you turned every little hiccup into its own Skill you'd drown in them – and your brain doesn't do that either. A memory sticks only if it repeats, or if it felt important.⁵⁸ So jot things down cheaply, but only promote the lessons that keep coming back. If a new one fits something you already know, fold it in instead of starting fresh.⁶ Do the tidying later, in a quiet pass, not mid-task⁷ – and let skills you never use fade.⁹ Grab fast, keep slowly, stay light. Your agent already has the genius; this just adds the part of the brain that keeps it.

THESE AREN'T MADE-UP EXAMPLES

Both skills above came straight out of one normal work session – not a staged demo. "17s/frame seems like a lot" became **macos-long-render**. "there was a citation problem" became **citations**. The lessons were already in the conversation; the system just **kept them** instead of letting them slip away at the end. That's the whole point – you capture from the chat you're already having. (Revolutionary, we know: writing things down.)

REFERENCES

LEARNING & MEMORY NEUROSCIENCE · ALL CHECKED

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in short: a small idea on top of things Claude already does – agentic loops and its memory + Skills. The neuroscience is just the *why*, not a new claim. Check your skills actually trigger with the

